WRENFORD BOROUGH COUNCIL

Defect Standard: Carriageway

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1. Purpose and scope

This standard sets out what a report of its defect type must show before a Highways Inspector may order a repair straight from the report, and what follows the decision.

It is used by the Street Care Coordinator or Highways Inspector who opens a review, by the Highways Inspector who decides it, and by the residents, businesses, councillors, bus operators and schools who report defects, as the Highways Policy describes.

Each defect type has its own defect standard. The five defect standards share one layout and many of the same sentences; they differ in what the defect type covers, in the requirements of section 4 and how section 5 reads them, and in what an inspection records, the writing that follows a decision and the reasons that sections 6 to 9 give. A report is always reviewed under the standard of its own defect type, and under the standard of its linked defect type where it has one; a requirement in one standard never applies to a report of another defect type unless the report is linked to it.

The standard applies to every report of its defect type, whichever channel it comes through.

2. What this standard covers

This standard covers defects in the carriageway of any street the council maintains: potholes, sunken areas, ridges and broken surfacing in the part of the street used by vehicles, cycle lanes included.

A pothole holding water from a blocked gully may be reported as a carriageway defect with drainage as its linked defect type, or the other way round, and either way the report must meet both standards. The carriageway and footway standards are written from one template and read almost alike; their requirements are not the same.

The defect type is Carriageway.

3. Who reports

A report is made by whoever sees the defect - a resident, a business, a councillor, a bus operator or a school - through one of three channels: the council website's report form, the StreetCare app on a phone, or a telephone call that the contact centre types up.

The report gives the street, its district and its street category, where on the street the defect is and whether that location is fixed, the defect type and any linked defect type, and the answers its requirements read. The council adds how many reports the same location has had before and the planned crew hours from its own standard times. The documents attached to a report - a resident description, a call note, a photo note or an inspection note from an earlier visit - describe the defect.

A report of this type gives the depth or vertical step of the defect, its width across and whether a photograph is attached.

4. Requirements

Every requirement below must be Met for a Highways Inspector to order a repair straight from the report. Each requirement is stated once, in one sentence, and a report is screened against all of them, in this order:

1 **Location fixed.** The location of the defect is fixed to a house number, a lamp column number or a road junction.

2 **Photograph.** A photograph of the defect is attached to the report.

3 **Depth.** The defect has a depth or a vertical step of at least 40 millimetres.

4 **Width.** The defect measures at least 150 millimetres and at most 1500 millimetres across.

A requirement is never met by a sentence in a statement, and is never waived.

5. Reading the requirements

Each requirement is Met, Not met or Not documented on the report as the Report Rules read it. The latest revision of a report is the report; an earlier revision is never screened.

- A location is fixed when the report ties the defect to a house number, a lamp column number or a road junction, so that a crew can find it without a search. The requirement is met when the report records the location fixed, not met when it records that it is not, and not documented when the answer is blank.
- A photograph attached to the report shows the defect as the reporter saw it. The requirement is met when the report records a photograph attached, not met when it records that it is not, and not documented when the answer is blank.
- The depth is the deepest point of the defect below the surface around it, or the height of a vertical step, in whole millimetres as the Report Rules read it from centimetres or inches. A depth of exactly the figure meets the requirement, a shallower one fails it, and a blank depth is not documented.
- The width is the largest measurement across the defect, in whole millimetres as the Report Rules read it. A width of exactly either figure meets the requirement. A narrower defect is too small to repair from the report, and a wider one is a failed surface whose repair needs an inspection to plan, so either fails it; a blank width is not documented.

A requirement that is not documented names the answers it needs, so that the inspection can find them.

A report with a linked defect type is screened under this standard and under the linked type's, and must meet both. The documents never decide a requirement. A measurement sentence whose figure differs from the report's own, or gives a figure the report left blank, is flagged for the Highways Inspector, and the report's answer still decides.

6. What an inspection records

When a report is sent for inspection on site, the inspector who visits records what this standard needs to decide the repair: the depth and the width of the defect, measured with a straight edge and a tape, a photograph taken from the footway, the location fixed to a house number, a lamp column or a junction, and whether the defect lies in a utility's reinstatement.

7. The works order

The works order goes to the council's repair contractor when a Highways Inspector orders a repair under this standard. It names the report by its report reference and defect type, says the repair is ordered, and gives the street, the location, the defect's own measurements and the repair this section names: a patch repair, or a permanent reinstatement for a defect wider than 600 millimetres or deeper than 75 millimetres. A linked defect type is named with its own repair. It asks the contractor to sign the work in the road and to leave the repair flush with the surface around it. The works order carries no figure from a model.

8. The resident update

The resident update is written after the works order, for the person who reported the defect. It tells them in plain words that a repair has been ordered, what will be done and where. For a carriageway defect it says that the pothole will be repaired and that the road may be signed while the crew works. Where the repair depends on a linked defect, the update says so. The update never gives the repeat likelihood, the expected crew hours or any other figure from a model, never promises when the work will be done, and never names any member of the council's staff.

9. Why these requirements

A pothole grows quickly once water gets under the surface, and a deep one can throw a cyclist or a motorcyclist off or damage a wheel. The council orders a repair straight from a report when the report shows a defect at the depth that section 4 gives and between its two widths, with the evidence a crew can act on: the location fixed and a photograph.

The carriageway is held to a deeper figure than the footway, because a wheel rides over a shallow dip that would trip a person walking.

Wider than the larger width of section 4, a defect is no longer a pothole but a failed surface, and an inspection plans its repair.

Highways Asset Management owns this standard, reviews it every twelve months and issues any amendment as a new issue of this document, replacing every earlier issue.